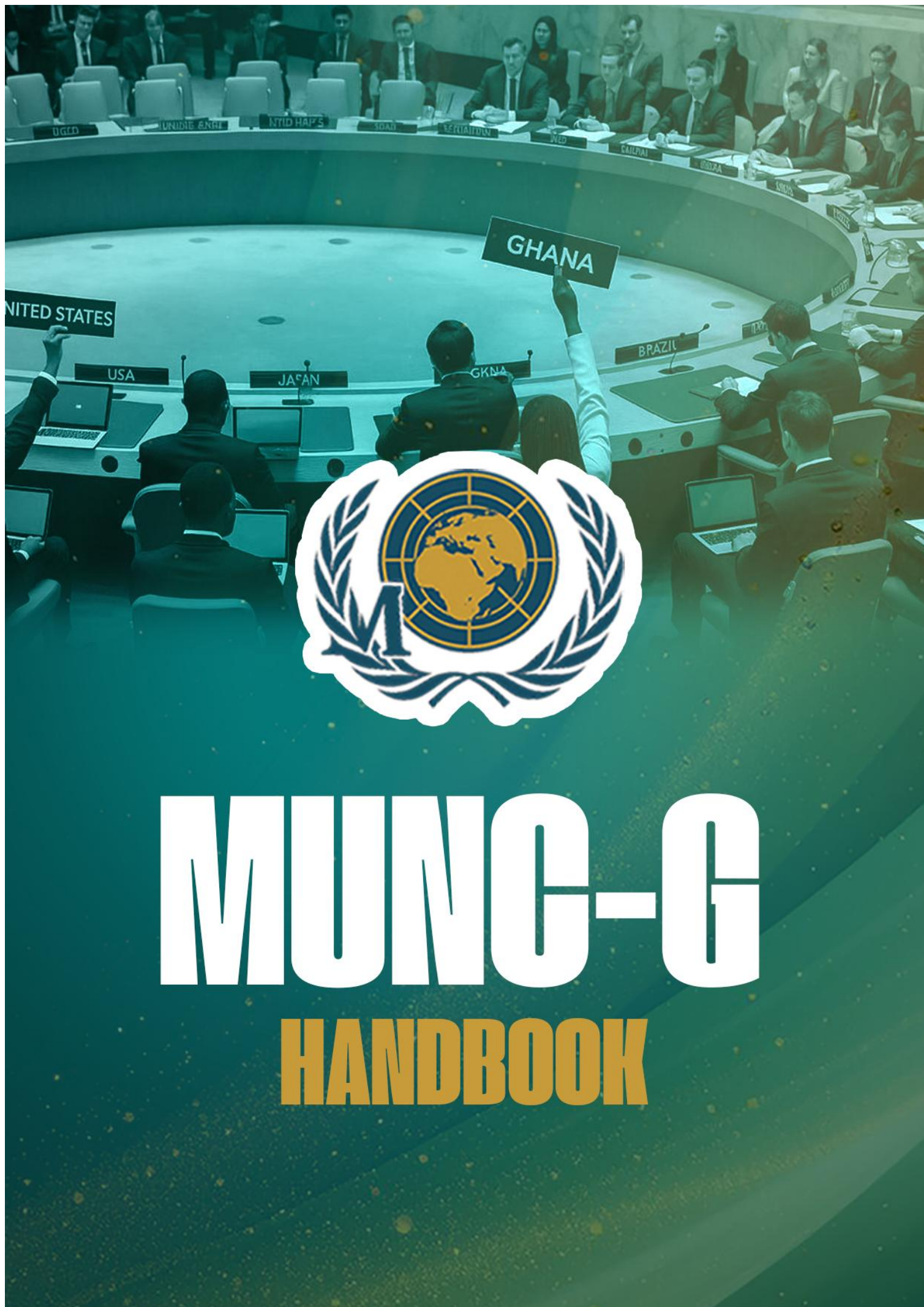




MUNG-G

HANDBOOK

Background & History of Model UN

Model United Nations (MUN) is an educational simulation of the United Nations. It began over seven decades ago as a classroom exercise to teach students about diplomacy, international relations, and the UN system. Early activities called “international assemblies” modeled the League of Nations – the first was at Oxford University in 1921. After World War II and the founding of the UN in 1945, Model UN simulations shifted focus to United Nations topics. The first recorded conference explicitly named Model United Nations took place at Swarthmore College on April 5, 1947, where 150 students from 41 colleges simulated the UN General Assembly. Since then, MUN has grown worldwide. Today, hundreds of thousands of students worldwide participate in Model UN conferences each year. These simulations span all educational levels, from basic school through to the university. As the UN notes, MUN helps students “develop public speaking, writing, negotiation and research skills” and introduces them to global issues like peace, security, human rights, and development. For example, in 2009 the United Nations itself held the first Global Model UN to bring together youth from around the world.

Educational Purpose

Participation in MUN builds one’s research, writing, public speaking, and negotiation skills. Students learn to work collaboratively, consider diverse perspectives, and seek diplomatic solutions. By simulating UN procedures and decision making, delegates gain insight into how real international policy is shaped.

MUNC GH will build on this tradition, giving delegates practical experience in diplomacy and collaboration while exploring today’s global challenges.

The Model United Nations Conference – Ghana, one of its kind here in Ghana, will be an annual and flagship conference for the MUNCGLOBAL organisation, bringing together youth from all areas in Ghana and Africa as a whole to simulate the UN and brainstorm to bring about effective and tangible solutions that can be implemented. This annual conference gives the opportunity to the youth to shape the next international policies that will govern them. We aim to enable the next generation of Ghanaian and African leaders, cultivating informed global citizens who can effectively engage in international affairs and matters. We envisage a world where the youth in Ghana use diplomatic skills to improve, reasonable solutions to global challenges. Our mission is to provide a dynamic platform for the youth of Ghana to learn about the United Nations and diplomacy. Through our conferences and training,

MUNC-GH cultivates a deep understanding of international affairs in society. We equip students with the needed skills and information to tackle interrelated worldwide issues. MUNC GH's core values imitate international cooperation and respect: inclusivity, open-mindedness, integrity, and commitment to peaceful problem solving. Delegates are expected to adhere to the UN's principles of diplomacy and mutual respect. The objectives of MUNC GH include promoting awareness of global issues such as the UN's Sustainable Development Goals, developing skills especially research and public speaking, fostering leadership and teamwork among one another in the country. Through committee simulations, MUNC GH will encourage delegates to always share their perspectives, negotiate settlements, and find consensus on demanding international issues aligning with the UN's goal of seeing world affairs from numerous perspectives. (WE FOR GET QUOTE FROM KOFI ANNAN THEN CARRY CHOCK)

Model United Nations conferences, success lies in the value of research and readiness of delegates participating, hence this comprehensive handbook which is in line with the MUN Handbook arranged with resources from UNA-USA and thoroughly reviewed by experts and veteran MUNers is to aid as a source of information and provide guidance

General Policies & Delegate Expectations

Delegates at MUNC GH are expected to conduct themselves professionally at all times. Key expectations include:

Professional Conduct: Delegates must act respectfully and responsibly during all events. Disruptive behavior, intimidation, or harassment of any kind will not be tolerated. Discriminatory remarks are strictly prohibited.

Dress Code: Formal business attire is required. Casuals should be avoided in committee sessions.

Preparedness: Delegates are expected to thoroughly research their assigned country and the agenda for the committee. Each delegate should arrive on time and bring necessary materials (e.g. position paper, research notes).

Committee Decorum: Always address the Chair and fellow delegates politely. Speak one at a time, raise a placard to be recognized, and follow the recognized speaking time. Electronic devices may be restricted. Delegates should keep their cell phones silent.

Honor & Courtesy: Treat others courteously. Do not interrupt; wait to be recognized by the Chair. If you have a question, use a point of parliamentary inquiry or information. Delegates should remain “in character” (acting as their country or assigned role) during formal proceedings.

Roles & Responsibilities

Delegates: Each delegate represents an assigned country or stakeholder in a committee. Delegates research their country's positions on the topics and formulate a clear stance, summarized in a position paper. During the conference, delegates participate in debate: they deliver speeches, propose ideas, negotiate with others, sponsor and co-sponsor resolutions, and vote on draft resolutions. Delegates must uphold their country's policy (even if it differs from their personal views) and work towards collaborative solutions.

Chairs and Vice-Chairs: A Dais consisting of a Chair and one or more Vice-Chairs or Rapporteurs and Secretaries leads every committee. The Chair manages the flow of debate: calling roll call, recognizing speakers, enforcing time limits, and explaining rules (including points and motions). The Chair remains neutral and ensures all delegates follow the rules of procedure. Vice-Chairs assist with these duties and may handle paperwork (e.g. recording speakers' list, tabulating votes, handling documents).

Faculty Advisors: Faculty advisors accompany their school's delegation. Their role is to mentor and support delegates outside of formal committee sessions. Advisors often help students prepare by offering guidance on research or practice debates (even running mock MUN sessions). However, during formal committee meetings, faculty advisors do not intervene in the debate or speak for the students. Instead, they ensure delegates stay organized, address any personal needs, and liaise with conference organizers if logistical issues arise.

Volunteers / Secretariat / Staff: MUNC GH may enlist volunteers (often experienced students or alumni) to help run the event. Volunteers might serve as timekeepers, note-passing assistants, technical support, ushers, registration clerks, or photographers. They ensure the conference runs smoothly.

Research & Writing Position Papers

The initial phase in preparing for a gratifying Model UN experience is to gather information. Delegates must thoroughly research their country's perspective on the committee's topics before the conference. Reliable sources include UN documents, government publications, think-tank analyses, and news media. The main objective of a delegate is to represent his or her assigned country as accurately as possible. Your effective research of your country should cover:

- Relevant information about your assigned country (sort of government, ideologies, allies, enemies, GDP, , economy, when it joined the UN and other important issues.)
- Your country's historical stance and actions on the issue.
- Relevant UN resolutions or treaties your country has supported or opposed.
- Economic, political, and social factors affecting the issue in your country.
- Proposed solutions or initiatives your country favors (e.g. programs, policies, financing).

An effective research on a committee agenda should cover:

- Identifying and understanding the issue on board and how it affects your country.
- What implementations your country has put in place to curb the problem.
- The aspect of the issue that greatly affects your country.
- How can your country be involved to solve it if not affected.
- What arguments will you be making on behalf of your country at the conference.
- How the stance of other countries affect your country's own.
- Data that will effectively back up your country's stance.

Position Papers

Once research is complete, write a position paper. These are usually one and a half page per agenda. A position paper is a brief report on your country's stance for each agenda topic. It demonstrates your preparation and helps others understand your approach.

Each section should flow logically. Use data to support points where possible. (Relevant statistics or quotes from your country's official statements strengthen your arguments.) Avoid overly emotional or personal language; focus on evidence-based analysis and rational proposals. It is very important to maintain a formal, diplomatic tone and write professionally in your papers.

A position paper typically includes:

Introduction/Background: A brief overview of the country, relevant history in relation to the agenda and committee as well as why the issue matters to it.

Current Situation: How the issue affects the country (economically, politically, socially).

Country Policy: The country's existing policies and actions related to the issue, with justifications.

Past Participation: Any relevant international commitments, conventions, or UN actions your country has taken part.

5. Proposed Solutions: What the country believes should be done (its recommendations) to address the issue.

6. Commitment to Cooperation: How your country is willing to collaborate or negotiate.

A strong position paper also proposes specific ideas for resolutions.

Requirements:

1. Keep your language clear and concise; avoid overly “flowery” wording. It should be about one and half page, typed, single spacing using Times New Roman font size 12.
2. Format the paper neatly indicating your committee, and topic at the top of the page (use your country’s seal or a letterhead template) to look official.
3. Use short paragraphs to make ideas separate and bullet points for clarity.
4. Cite data and quotes with footnotes if required.
5. Do not ever use the first person pronoun in your position paper and even speeches; instead use your delegation’s name, our country, we, our government.
6. Finally, proofread carefully: editing and clarity check is essential.

A well-crafted position paper not only clarifies your country’s stance but also provides a solid foundation for your opening speech and debate arguments.

Sample position paper.

Committee - United Nations Population Funds (UNFPA)



The Republic of Comoros

The issue before the committee is:

Nurturing hope and leadership skills among young people.

Comoros is generally considered a country in need of aid. It is a small island nation with limited resources and faces various challenges such as poverty and health issues. The UNFPA and other international donors often provide support to help improve living conditions. In a 2023 interview, President Assoumani highlighted the nation's focus on youth employment, stating, "Youth employment is a priority for the government and for us as the UN." He emphasized collaboration with international organizations to invest in youth empowerment initiatives. Collaboration between UNFPA and Comoros.

- UNFPA supports programs that equip young people in Comoros with leadership skills, civic engagement opportunities, and platforms to participate in decision making processes.
- The organization works with the government of Comoros to provide access to reproductive health education and services for youth, ensuring they can make informed decisions about their futures.
- In Comoros, young people face challenges such as unemployment, limited access to quality education, and vulnerability to social issues. UNFPA collaborates with local authorities and NGOs to address these barriers, fostering an environment of inclusivity and opportunity.

As of December 2024, specific data on UNFPA's spending for youth empowerment programs in Comoros for the years 2023 and 2024 is not publicly available. The most recent detailed financial information pertains to the year 2021, during which UNFPA allocated \$24,786 towards youth empowerment initiatives in Comoros. This funding was implemented jointly by the government and UNFPA, with contributions of \$15,314 and \$9,472 respectively. The funding sources comprised 38% from core resources and 62% from non-core resources.

The Union of the Comoros has demonstrated a commitment to nurturing hope and developing leadership skills among its youth through various national policies and international collaborations. Key initiatives include:

Promoting Youth Employment Project: Supported by the World Bank, this project aims to improve access to income-generating opportunities for targeted youth in Comoros, thereby fostering economic empowerment and leadership skills.

International Youth Leadership Conferences: Comoros has hosted events such as the International Youth Leadership Conference, providing platforms for young leaders to discuss and engage in global issues, thereby enhancing their leadership skills and fostering hope for the future.

Comoros envisions a future where its youth are empowered, hopeful, and equipped with the leadership skills to drive national development. This aligns with global sustainable development goals, ensuring that young people are at the forefront of innovation, equality, and resilience. By nurturing leadership and hope, Comoros is not just investing in its young population but also securing a brighter and more inclusive future for the nation.

<https://www.unfpa.org/data/transparency-portal/unfpa-comoros>

[https://projects.worldbank.org/en/projects-operations/project-detail/P156195?](https://projects.worldbank.org/en/projects-operations/project-detail/P156195?locations=US)

Overview of the Flow of Debate

Model UN debate follows a structured process. According to MUN trainers, a typical committee session moves through four stages:

Opening Debate: The conference begins with roll call (introducing delegations) and a motion to open debate.

Setting the Agenda (Organizing Priorities): Delegates may propose an agenda (which topic to discuss first) via motions to open specific speakers' lists. The Committee votes on which topic to address first (usually done in committees with two agendas on board). Once the agenda is set, a Speakers' List is opened for formal debate on that topic.

Formal & Informal Debate: This is the main phase. Delegates take turns speaking according to the Speakers' List (formal debate). They can also move motions for Moderated Caucuses (short thematic discussions guided by the Chair) or Unmoderated Caucuses (informal open discussion) to expedite negotiation. During these caucuses, delegates often form working groups to draft resolutions and discuss ideas.

Resolution & Amendment Discussion and Voting: As draft resolutions and amendments are introduced, they are read to the committee (sometimes followed by a Q&A). Delegates debate each proposal. Eventually, motions are made to vote on passing resolutions. After voting (often at least two-thirds majority for General Assembly style), the resolution is adopted, and the committee can adjourn.

Below is the detailed format for the flow of debate.

Roll Call:

The Chair calls out all country names. Delegates say “present” or “present and voting” to register attendance. Responding “present” prevents you from partaking in voting proceedings during the committee session while responding “present and voting” give you the chance to partake in voting proceedings. This establishes quorum and officially opens the session.

Setting the Agenda:

If the committee has multiple topics, delegates may motion to set the agenda (choose which topic to address first). This may involve establishing a primary speakers’ list for each topic. If only one topic is scheduled, the Chair proceeds directly to opening debate.

Speakers’ List – Formal Debate:

Once the agenda is set, the Chair asks who wants to be on the speakers’ list. The Chair then recognizes delegates in order (each uses a set speaking time, e.g. 1-2 minutes) to present their country’s position and suggestions, most at times position papers are read over here. Initial speeches typically outline the delegate’s background on the topic and broad proposals. After a few speeches, delegates usually caucus to start detailed work.

Informal Debate (Caucuses):

Moderated Caucus: A delegate motions (requests) a moderated caucus with a specific time (e.g. 10 minutes total, 1-minute per speech). The Chair passes this motion by majority vote, and then recognizes speakers one by one under the moderated format. The Chair calls on delegates in turn, each making a short speech on a subtopic. It is a mini speaking list on a focused issue. A delegate who proposes a moderated caucus may speak first or last in it. This is used to focus on sub-issues (e.g. a region or specific aspect of the agenda).

Unmoderated Caucus: Delegates motion for an unmoderated caucus (recess of formal debate) of a set duration (e.g. 30 minutes). If passed, delegates mingle freely to discuss and work on draft resolutions together. No formal speaking; ideal for negotiation and writing, delegates must leave their seats and informally meet (often in continental blocs or allies) to brainstorm and draft resolutions.

(Remember: Caucus times can often be extended by motion for half the original time.)

These caucuses alternate with the speakers' list debate. For example, after initial positions, delegates break into caucuses to form blocs and write drafts. Then the committee reconvenes for more formal speakers' list speeches about bloc positions and final negotiations. The exact pattern depends on committee style.

Resolution Drafting:

During unmoderated caucuses, the writing process begins: sponsors of an idea write a working paper (which may become a draft resolution). Once a draft is ready and has enough signatories, it is submitted to the Chair for consideration.

Closing Debate:

When delegates feel their positions are clearly represented and there are ready with draft resolutions, and the draft from all continental blocs are added to become the committee's actual resolution, a delegate may motion to close debate on the topic. If approved (usually by majority or consensus), the committee moves to the voting procedure.

Voting Procedure:

Voting proceeds in order: first on any amendments, then on draft resolutions of all continental blocs. (In councils like the Security Council, the special veto rule applies.) Typically, the Chair reads each clause of the resolution or amendment, delegates debate it, and then votes. Finally, they vote on the entire resolution text.

Next Topic or Adjournment:

If more topics are on the agenda, the flow repeats for the next topic. Otherwise, the Chair formally adjourns the committee.

Throughout, delegates use motions to move between these stages (e.g. motion to table debate or adjourn) and points to manage the proceedings. This “flow of debate” ensures an organized progression from opening remarks to final resolutions.

Motions, Points, Yields & Rights

Formal points and motions are how delegates control procedure. They must be used correctly according to the rules of procedure.

Points: These are questions or requests addressed to the Chair or another delegate, outside the substantive agenda. Key points include:

- **Point of Order:** Use this to correct a procedural mistake, or if rules are broken. This can interrupt a speaker. If justified, the Chair immediately rules on the point.
- **Point of Parliamentary Inquiry:** Use to ask the Chair a question about rules or clarification on a procedure.
- **Point of Personal Privilege:** Raise this if you have a personal problem affecting you or you want to attend to something. These are urgent requests related to a delegate’s ability to participate.
- **Point of Information:** Use after a delegate’s speech, you may raise this to request clarification from the speaker.

- **Point of Correction:** Use to correct a statement made by the last speaker or other delegates in the committee.

Points do not require a vote; the Chair usually answers them immediately.

Motions: Delegates motion to take official actions. Common motions include:

- **Motion to Open/Close Debate:** Use in starting or ending a debate on the current agenda (used chiefly after setting an agenda or when the committee is done discussing the agenda).
- **Motion to Set Agenda:** Proposes which agenda topic to discuss next if there are multiple topics. The committee votes on this motion to order the topics.
- **Motion for a Moderated Caucus:** Proposes a timed, topic-specific discussion related to the agenda. The motion must specify total time, speaking time, and topic (e.g. “Motion for a 10-minute moderated caucus on effects of child labour”). If passed, delegates speak in order without a pre-set speakers list. Moderated caucuses are more formal compared to the unmoderated caucus (Chair calls on speakers).
- **Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus:** Proposes an informal breakout (e.g. “Motion for a 15-minute unmoderated caucus on drafting resolutions or working papers”). Delegates may move freely to confer.
- **Motion to Introduce Draft/Resolution:** When delegates have a draft resolution or amendment ready, they motion to introduce it. If seconded, the draft is read by its sponsor(s) and enters debate.
- **Motion to Adjourn Meeting:** Ends the committee session (typically at official adjournment time or conference’s close).

Using motions effectively is crucial. Points and motions “outline how topics are prioritized, the way resolutions are voted on, and they facilitate the general flow of debate”. Always wait to be recognized by the Chair before moving or answering a motion or point.

Yielding Time: During a formal speech, a delegate may use only part of their allotted time. They then “yield” the remaining time: either back to the Chair or to another delegate. Yielding to another delegate allows that person to speak next (a strategic move in many debates).

Right of Reply: If a delegate is receives a comment, attacked or insulted during debate (e.g. another delegate says something offensive about their country), they may request a “right of reply.” The Chair grants limited time to respond. This is a rare, last-resort point used only for direct offenses.

Understanding and practicing these terms allows delegates to participate fully and strategically in MUN procedure.

Public Speaking Tips

Start your speeches with “Honorable Chair, Distinguished Delegates” to set the tone. This acknowledges your audience respectfully and signals decorum. E.g.: Thank you the chair the house...

- **Prepare Thoroughly:** Know your country’s stance and facts inside out. Researching well will make you more confident to speak. Understand key terms and practice pronunciation to avoid fumbling.
- **Structure Your Speech:** Even short speeches should have a clear beginning (e.g. thank the Chair, introduce your position), middle (your country’s perspective and proposals) and end (a call to action or willingness to negotiate). Bullet-point your main ideas to stay organized. (For example, one guide suggests including: issue background, how it affects your country, your country’s position, actions to date, and proposed solutions.)
- **Use the “4Cs”:** Effective speakers are Confident, Clear, Concise, and Constructive, speak with passion, and maintain composure. Confidence comes from preparation; stand tall, make eye contact, and project your voice. Speak clearly and avoid fillers (e.g. “um,” “like,” “you know”). Be concise – use simple language and get to the point.
- **Engage the Audience:** Vary your tone and pace to maintain interest. Emphasize important words. If rules allow notes, use them sparingly; eventually try to make brief speeches from memory. Remember to modulate your voice (not too fast or monotone) and use natural gestures (without overdoing it).

- **Rehearse and Get Feedback:** Practice your opening speech aloud, and ideally in front of a teacher or friends. Time yourself. Review recordings if possible. Critique your posture, clarity, and pacing. The more you practice, the less nervous you will be.
- **Be Respectful:** Even when disagreeing, remain polite and diplomatic in tone. Use formal addresses (“Honourable Chair,” “Distinguished delegates”) and thank other speakers when relevant. If you concede a good point by another delegate, acknowledge it. This professionalism strengthens your credibility.

By focusing on preparation, clarity, and confidence, delegates can greatly improve their speaking.

Resolution Writing

Drafting resolutions is a central part of MUN. A resolution is a formal document that expresses the committee's collective decisions and proposed solutions. It is a legal document that expresses the general opinion of the committee. The resolution's structure must follow specific rules:

1. Heading (Resolution Introduction): At the top, include the committee name, topic, and resolution title. List all Sponsors (delegates who drafted and fully support the resolution) and Signatories (delegates who support discussing it). Sponsors and signatories give credit to contributors.

2. Preambulatory Clauses: These are opening clauses that contextualize the issue. They acknowledge the problem, cite relevant facts, or refer to past UN actions. Each preamble begins with a present participle (e.g. Recalling, Recognizing, Alarmed by) and ends with a comma. These clauses build the case for action. For example: "Deeply concerned by the rise of cyber-crime globally, and recognizing the need for international collaboration,

3. Operative Clauses: These clauses propose actions the committee will take. Each begins with a verb (e.g. Encourages, Requests, Calls upon, the last clause ends with a full stop). Operative clauses are numbered and each clause ends with a semicolon except the final clause that ends with a period. They should be specific and actionable. For example: "1. Establishes an international task force to monitor cyber-security threats; 2. Encourages Member States to share intelligence on cyber-criminal networks."

4. Amendments: Delegates can propose changes to draft resolutions. There are friendly amendments (all original sponsors approve; no vote needed) and unfriendly amendments (not approved by all sponsors; requires a vote). Amendments can add, delete, or modify clauses. Friendly amendments are usually submitted before debate starts.

Unfriendly amendments are introduced during debate via motion and voted on. Familiarize yourself with both types.

SAMPLE RESOLUTION PAPER

General Assembly — Plenary

Resolution GA/ENV/1.1

Sponsors: Ghana, United States of America, China, India, Brazil and Germany

Signatories: France, United Kingdom, Japan, Canada, Nigeria, Sweden and Kenya

Topic: “Resolving Climate Change in Our World”

The General Assembly,

Recognizing the urgent and interlinked nature of climate change and sustainable development, and recalling the Paris Agreement and the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development,

Deeply concerned by rising global temperatures, increasing frequency of extreme weather events, sea-level rise, and their disproportionate impacts on vulnerable and low-income countries,

Alarmed by the continuing gap between nationally determined contributions and the emission reductions required to limit global warming to well below 2°C, and preferably to 1.5°C above pre-industrial levels,

Acknowledging the crucial role of scientific research, technology transfer and capacity-building in enabling adaptation and mitigation efforts worldwide,

Emphasizing the importance of nature-based solutions, energy transition, sustainable urban planning, and resilient infrastructure to reduce emissions and enhance adaptation capacity,

Guided by the need to protect human rights and to ensure a just transition that supports workers and communities affected by decarbonization,

Resolved to strengthen international cooperation to accelerate ambition, finance and implementation of climate action,

1. Calls upon Member States to increase the ambition of their nationally determined contributions (NDCs) with the aim of aligning national policies with limiting global temperature rise to 1.5°C;
2. Urges developed countries to scale up climate finance to meet and exceed existing commitments, including through predictable and additional public finance for adaptation and mitigation in developing countries;
3. Encourages the establishment of a dedicated international Climate Adaptation and Resilience Fund within existing UN financial architecture to support vulnerability assessments, adaptation planning, and implementation in least developed countries and small island developing states;
4. Requests the Secretary-General, in coordination with relevant UN agencies, to convene a Technology and Knowledge Exchange Platform to facilitate transfer of climate-friendly technologies, best practices, and capacity-building programs to developing countries;
5. Calls for accelerated efforts to phase out greenhouse-gas intensive subsidies and to promote incentives for renewable energy, energy efficiency, and low-emission technologies, including through public-private financing mechanisms and green bonds;
6. Supports member State adoption of national policies for a just transition, including social protection, retraining programs for affected workers, and investment in green job creation, particularly in regions highly dependent on fossil fuel industries;

7. Encourages urban and national planners to integrate nature-based solutions and resilient infrastructure standards into planning processes to reduce climate risk, protect biodiversity, and promote sustainable land use;
8. Requests improved global monitoring and reporting by strengthening national greenhouse gas inventories and enhancing transparency frameworks under UN processes to ensure comparability, reliability and accountability;
9. Calls upon Member States to implement measures to reduce short-lived climate pollutants (e.g., methane, black carbon) through targeted regulations and industry partnerships, recognizing their rapid climate and health benefits;
10. Encourages the creation of regional centers of excellence for climate science, adaptation and early-warning systems, supported by voluntary contributions and international collaboration, to improve preparedness and disaster risk reduction.